

FretGarden Pedagogical Constitution

PEDAGOGICAL STANDARD

Chapter 2 - Learning-Objective Taxonomy and Evidence Medicine 1.0	
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This document forms part of the FretGarden Pedagogical Constitution. Normative terms are used according to the Foundation.

Contents

1. Purpose
2. Constitutional Authority
3. The Objective-Evidence Principle
4. Core Distinctions
 - 4.1 Topic Is Not Objective
 - 4.2 Activity Is Not Objective
 - 4.3 Performance Is Not Necessarily Learning
 - 4.4 Correctness Is Not Necessarily Understanding
 - 4.5 Difficulty Is Not Evidence
 - 4.6 Quantity Is Not Quality
 - 4.7 Confidence Is Not Competence
5. Structure of a FretGarden Learning Objective
 - 5.1 Capability
 - 5.2 Content
 - 5.3 Conditions
 - 5.4 Quality Standard
 - 5.5 Scope
 - 5.6 Time Horizon
 - 5.7 Degree of Independence
6. Objective Grammar
7. Learning-Objective Taxonomy
8. Domain I - Orientation Objectives
9. Domain II - Perception Objectives
10. Domain III - Knowledge-Retrieval Objectives
11. Domain IV - Conceptual-Reasoning Objectives
12. Domain V - Fretboard-Navigation Objectives
13. Domain VI - Physical-Execution Objectives
14. Domain VII - Temporal-Control Objectives
15. Domain VIII - Musical-Application and Creation Objectives
16. Domain IX - Metacognitive-Practice Objectives
17. Cross-Domain Objectives
18. Objective Levels
19. Objective Granularity
20. Evidence Model Overview
21. Evidence Sources
22. Evidence Conditions
23. Evidence Quality Dimensions
24. Evidence Strength
25. Claim Hierarchy
26. Evidence Rules by Claim
27. Validity
28. Reliability
29. Evidence Sampling

- 30. Error Evidence
- 31. Partial Success
- 32. Prompt Dependence
- 33. Familiarity and Novelty
- 34. Retention
- 35. Fluency
- 36. Mastery
- 37. Readiness and Progression
- 38. Evidence Profiles
- 39. Confidence in Claims
- 40. Objective Alignment
- 41. Lesson Objective Requirements
- 42. Exercise Objective Requirements
- 43. Assessment Objective Requirements
- 44. Review Objective Requirements
- 45. Diagnostic Objectives
- 46. Negative and Missing Evidence
- 47. Evidence Expiration and Revalidation
- 48. Learner-Facing Claims
- 49. Conformance Tests
- 50. Examples of Compliant Objectives
 - 50.1 Note Retrieval
 - 50.2 Interval Construction
 - 50.3 Rhythmic Execution
 - 50.4 Chord-Tone Application
 - 50.5 Practice Regulation
- 51. Examples of Noncompliant Objectives
- 52. Constitutional Non-Negotiables
- 53. Tradeoffs and Resolution Rules
- 54. Assumptions Made
- 55. Unresolved Questions
- 56. Topics Intentionally Deferred
- 57. Required Future Cross-References
- 58. Chapter Conformance Statement

Chapter 2 - Learning-Objective Taxonomy and Evidence Model

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1. Purpose

This chapter defines how FretGarden describes intended learning and how it determines whether learning has occurred. It establishes the learning-objective taxonomy, which defines the kinds of change an educational activity may legitimately seek to produce, and the evidence model, which defines what observations are sufficient to support claims about exposure, performance, learning, retention, transfer, fluency, and mastery.

These systems are necessary because inconsistency often begins before a lesson is written. When objectives are vague, lesson content becomes unfocused. When evidence requirements are undefined, assessment becomes arbitrary. When different authors use words such as understand, know, master, or complete differently, progression rules become unstable and learner records become misleading.

A lesson cannot be designed coherently unless its intended result is defined. An assessment cannot be valid unless the result it claims to measure is defined. A progression decision cannot be justified unless the evidence required for readiness is defined.

This chapter does not prescribe a complete curriculum sequence, universal scoring thresholds, specific exercise formats, or application interfaces. It establishes the normative foundation those later chapters must use.

2. Constitutional Authority

This chapter operationalizes the foundational commitments that every lesson must produce an observable change; mastery must not be inferred from completion; assessment must match the capability it claims to measure; recognition, recall, retention, transfer, fluency, and mastery are distinct; core knowledge must be retrieved, reviewed after delay, and applied; evidence must support the strength of the claim being made; and educational function takes precedence over superficial format.

When another specification uses learning-objective or evidence terminology inconsistently with this chapter, this chapter governs unless a later constitutional amendment explicitly supersedes it.

3. The Objective-Evidence Principle

Every core educational objective **MUST** be paired with an evidence statement.

An objective statement defines the capability FretGarden intends the learner to develop. An evidence statement defines what the learner must do, under what conditions, and with what degree of quality for FretGarden to reasonably infer that the capability exists.

The objective and evidence statement **MUST** be designed together. The governing sequence is:

- 1 define the intended capability;
- 2 define the conditions under which it should be available;
- 3 define the evidence that would demonstrate it;
- 4 identify prerequisite capabilities;
- 5 design instruction and practice;
- 6 select an assessment method;
- 7 determine how the evidence will be interpreted; and
- 8 establish when the capability must be checked again.

4. Core Distinctions

4.1 Topic Is Not Objective

A topic identifies subject matter. An objective identifies what the learner will be able to do with that subject matter. “Major thirds” is a topic. “Construct and identify major thirds from varied roots” is an objective.

4.2 Activity Is Not Objective

Reading, listening, watching, playing five repetitions, or completing ten questions are activities. They may support learning but do not define the intended result.

4.3 Performance Is Not Necessarily Learning

Performance is an observable attempt under current conditions. Learning is a relatively durable change in capability. Immediate correct performance provides evidence, but the strength of that evidence depends on prompting, familiarity, guessing probability, delay, and variation.

4.4 Correctness Is Not Necessarily Understanding

A correct response may result from memory, recognition, calculation, imitation, chance, or understanding. FretGarden MUST interpret correctness in relation to the intended capability.

4.5 Difficulty Is Not Evidence

A difficult activity may still measure the wrong capability. Added speed, notation, strings, or complexity MUST be relevant to the claim.

4.6 Quantity Is Not Quality

More attempts may increase confidence, but quantity cannot repair invalid evidence. Repeated recognition cannot establish free recall when free recall was never required.

4.7 Confidence Is Not Competence

Self-reported confidence MAY supplement evidence. It MUST NOT replace direct evidence for core capabilities.

5. Structure of a FretGarden Learning Objective

Every formal objective **MUST** specify capability, content, conditions, quality standard, scope, time horizon, and degree of independence.

5.1 Capability

The objective must use an observable or inferable action such as detect, distinguish, identify, recall, locate, construct, explain, classify, compare, predict, perform, maintain, adapt, analyze, improvise, compose, diagnose, select, or justify.

“Understand” **MAY** appear only when followed by a precise statement of what understanding enables.

5.2 Content

The objective must identify the musical content or relationship to which the capability applies.

5.3 Conditions

Relevant conditions may include instrument access, roots, strings, fret range, diagrams, delay, key, tempo, metronome, representation, or musical context.

5.4 Quality Standard

The objective must identify relevant quality dimensions such as accuracy, rhythmic stability, response consistency, tone, control, independence, explanatory precision, or transfer.

5.5 Scope

Every claim must have defined boundaries. A mastery claim cannot be broader than the objective's scope.

5.6 Time Horizon

The objective must distinguish guided same-session performance, independent performance, short-delay retention, long-delay retention, and continuing fluency where relevant.

5.7 Degree of Independence

Permitted support must be stated. A capability demonstrated only with full support **MUST NOT** be recorded as independent.

6. Objective Grammar

Formal objectives **SHOULD** follow this structure:

Given [conditions], the learner will [capability] [content and scope] with [quality standard], using no more than [permitted support], and will reproduce or apply the capability after [time horizon or transfer condition] where required.

Example:

Given a named natural-note root on the sixth or fifth string between the open string and twelfth fret, the learner will locate the major third above that root in at least two adjacent-string configurations, identify the interval by name, and play both notes in time at a controlled tempo without a visual interval diagram.

7. Learning-Objective Taxonomy

The FretGarden taxonomy contains nine domains:

- 1 orientation;
- 2 perception;
- 3 knowledge retrieval;
- 4 conceptual reasoning;
- 5 fretboard navigation;
- 6 physical execution;
- 7 temporal control;
- 8 musical application and creation; and
- 9 metacognitive practice.

A lesson MAY target multiple domains, but it MUST identify its primary domain and SHOULD limit simultaneously novel secondary demands.

8. Domain I - Orientation Objectives

Orientation objectives establish the ability to recognize the task, representation, instrument region, terminology, or practice procedure necessary to begin meaningful work.

Examples include identifying string names, distinguishing fret numbers from finger numbers, interpreting a basic fretboard diagram, recognizing a root marker, identifying the beat unit of a metronome setting, or explaining the purpose of a focused practice interval.

Orientation prevents representational confusion from being misclassified as musical failure. It MUST NOT be treated as evidence of deeper musical capability.

9. Domain II - Perception Objectives

Perception objectives concern the ability to attend to, detect, distinguish, recognize, anticipate, or internally hear musical features.

Subtypes include detection, discrimination, identification, relational hearing, prediction, and audiation.

Perception evidence MUST involve sound or internal hearing in a way necessary to complete the task. A learner must not be able to succeed solely through visual recognition when the claim concerns hearing.

A single binary choice is weak evidence. Confidence increases through multiple examples, varied roots and contexts, reproduction, explanation, and delayed success.

10. Domain III - Knowledge-Retrieval Objectives

Knowledge-retrieval objectives concern access to names, facts, formulas, locations, relationships, or procedures from memory.

Subtypes include recognition, cued recall, free recall, reconstruction, and procedural recall.

Evidence MUST match the required retrieval level. Recognition cannot establish free recall. A visible fretboard cannot establish unaided note-location recall. Support is part of the evidence.

11. Domain IV - Conceptual-Reasoning Objectives

Conceptual-reasoning objectives concern explaining, deriving, comparing, classifying, predicting, analyzing, and justifying musical relationships.

They reveal whether the learner possesses an organized model rather than isolated answers. Evidence should require relationships to be exposed through derivation, comparison, explanation, correction, prediction, or application.

Conceptual ability **MUST NOT** be measured only through polished prose. Spoken explanation, diagrams, note selection, ordered steps, and physical demonstration may also reveal reasoning.

12. Domain V - Fretboard-Navigation Objectives

Fretboard-navigation objectives concern locating, connecting, and using musical relationships across the instrument.

Subtypes include absolute location, relative location, pattern recognition, pattern reconstruction, position connection, multi-anchor navigation, and functional navigation.

Evidence should vary roots, starting locations, string sets, and context. Shape recognition alone does not establish note knowledge, interval knowledge, or function.

13. Domain VI - Physical-Execution Objectives

Physical-execution objectives concern performing intentional movements with sufficient control, accuracy, tone, coordination, and physical sustainability.

Subtypes include isolated movement, coordinated movement, pattern execution, transition execution, articulation, and adaptive execution.

Evidence should consider relevant combinations of pitch accuracy, movement, tone, noise control, tension, timing, repeatability, and recovery. A single successful attempt is insufficient for stable execution.

14. Domain VII - Temporal-Control Objectives

Temporal-control objectives concern perceiving, maintaining, subdividing, organizing, and intentionally placing musical events in time.

Subtypes include pulse detection, pulse maintenance, subdivision, rhythmic decoding, rhythmic execution, synchronization, temporal independence, tempo adaptation, and groove or placement.

Temporal evidence must reveal the relationship between learner action and pulse. Merely performing while a metronome sounds does not prove synchronization.

15. Domain VIII - Musical-Application and Creation Objectives

Application and creation objectives concern using acquired capability for musical purposes.

Subtypes include contextual performance, harmonic application, improvisation, composition, variation, analytical application, and interpretation.

Evidence must involve meaningful choice or adaptation. Copying a demonstration may provide execution evidence but limited application evidence. Open-ended tasks should be evaluated by constraints, coherence, intentionality, and use of the target concept.

16. Domain IX - Metacognitive-Practice Objectives

Metacognitive-practice objectives concern planning, observing, evaluating, and adjusting one's learning process.

Subtypes include goal selection, difficulty regulation, error detection, error diagnosis, strategy selection, progress evaluation, session regulation, review planning, and reflection.

Evidence should involve actual decisions, such as selecting a tempo, isolating a passage, revising a practice plan, or accurately evaluating stability. Advice recognition alone is insufficient.

17. Cross-Domain Objectives

Integrated musical tasks often require several domains. Cross-domain objectives are appropriate when integration is the target, but they **MUST NOT** conceal undefined subskills.

Before assigning an integrated task, designers must identify component prerequisites, the primary developing capability, expected errors, and how failure will be diagnosed.

18. Objective Levels

FretGarden defines the following developmental levels:

- 1 Unencountered - no intentional exposure;
- 2 Oriented - recognizes purpose, representation, or procedure;
- 3 Guided - performs with direct support;
- 4 Reconstructed - produces with partial cues and deliberate reasoning;
- 5 Independent - performs under familiar conditions without solution support;
- 6 Stable - reproduces across attempts and minor changes;
- 7 Retained - remains available after delay;
- 8 Transferable - applies in meaningfully different contexts;
- 9 Fluent - reliable, efficient, accurate, and adaptable;
- 10 Integrated - participates effectively in broader musicianship and self-directed practice.

These levels are not mechanically cumulative in every domain. A learner may transfer through deliberate reasoning before becoming fast, or execute a physical pattern fluently without conceptual integration. Every label **MUST** refer to a specified objective and evidence type.

19. Objective Granularity

Objectives must be small enough to guide instruction and assessment, but large enough to represent meaningful capability.

Atomic objectives represent one coherent capability. Composite objectives combine naturally related atomic objectives. Program-level objectives describe long-term outcomes and **MUST** be decomposed before assessment.

20. Evidence Model Overview

Evidence is information that supports an inference about a defined capability. A score is only a summary of responses and is not equivalent to evidence.

The evidence model distinguishes source, condition, quality, strength, recency, consistency, independence, and relevance.

21. Evidence Sources

Permitted evidence sources include selected response, constructed response, instrumental performance, vocal or rhythmic performance, explanation, reconstruction, analysis, creation, self-evaluation, and longitudinal observation.

Each source has limits. Selected response is efficient but susceptible to guessing. Constructed response strengthens retrieval evidence. Instrumental performance may reveal execution, navigation, timing, and application depending on observation. Self-evaluation is useful for metacognition but requires calibration.

22. Evidence Conditions

Evidence should record relevant conditions, including prompting level, familiarity, time since instruction, response time, context, representation, instrumental conditions, and external support.

Performance without contextual conditions may be difficult or impossible to interpret accurately.

23. Evidence Quality Dimensions

Evidence quality may include accuracy, consistency, independence, stability, retention, transfer, fluency, explanatory coherence, musical quality, and self-correction.

The relevant dimensions depend on the objective. Partial success **SHOULD** be preserved by dimension rather than collapsed into one misleading judgment.

24. Evidence Strength

Weak evidence is based on limited attempts, heavy prompting, high guessing probability, exact practiced examples, or immediate testing. It may support introduced or developing status.

Moderate evidence includes repeated correctness, reduced prompting, some variation, constructed response, or familiar application.

Strong evidence includes independent response, multiple attempts, delayed retrieval, varied context, transfer, low guessing probability, explanation, reconstruction, or musical application.

Broad claims **SHOULD** use converging evidence from more than one relevant method.

25. Claim Hierarchy

FretGarden distinguishes the following claims:

- 1 exposure;
- 2 participation;
- 3 immediate performance;
- 4 guided capability;
- 5 independent capability;
- 6 stable capability;
- 7 retention;
- 8 transfer;
- 9 fluency;
- 10 mastery; and
- 11 integration.

Each claim requires stronger or differently structured evidence. A mastery claim requires independent, stable, retained, transferable performance and any domain-specific quality required for future use.

26. Evidence Rules by Claim

Exposure cannot be upgraded automatically. One correct attempt is insufficient for mastery. Recognition cannot establish recall. Immediate performance cannot establish retention. Identical repetition cannot establish broad transfer. High accuracy under heavy prompting cannot establish independence. Speed cannot compensate for inaccuracy. Explanation cannot always replace performance, and performance cannot always replace explanation. Self-report cannot establish core capability alone.

27. Validity

Validity concerns whether evidence supports its interpretation.

Content validity requires representative scope. Construct validity requires measurement of the intended capability rather than unrelated demands. Consequential validity requires that assessment incentives not distort practice. Instructional validity requires results useful for next steps. Ecological validity requires meaningful musical evidence when the claim concerns real use.

28. Reliability

Reliability concerns whether similar capability produces reasonably consistent evidence. It is improved through multiple observations, clear criteria, controlled conditions, equivalent items, reduced guessing, and consistent interpretation.

Reliability MUST NOT be pursued by narrowing a task until it no longer represents the intended capability. A reliable invalid assessment remains unacceptable.

29. Evidence Sampling

No assessment can test every item. Sampling must represent the scope, give stronger coverage to foundational or high-risk capabilities, permit adaptive evidence collection near decision boundaries, and avoid excessive testing that displaces learning.

30. Error Evidence

Errors may reveal missing knowledge, unstable recall, representational confusion, rhythmic misunderstanding, excessive tempo, physical coordination failure, inattentive practice, misconception, or transfer failure.

Useful categories include isolated error, patterned error, systematic misconception, execution breakdown, retrieval failure, timing failure, transfer failure, and attention failure.

Error categories **MUST** guide remediation and **MUST NOT** judge the learner's character.

31. Partial Success

FretGarden **SHOULD** preserve relevant dimensions of partial success: correct notes with unstable rhythm, correct structure with incorrect spelling, correct shape with an unidentified root, accurate but slow recall, or accurate performance only at reduced tempo.

Partial evidence informs next steps but **MUST NOT** be inflated into full mastery.

32. Prompt Dependence

Support levels are full support, structured support, partial support, minimal support, and independent performance.

Support must be faded deliberately. Repeated success with unchanged support establishes a supported task, not necessarily the underlying independent capability.

33. Familiarity and Novelty

Evidence conditions may involve identical context, near transfer, farther transfer, or novel integration.

Transfer demands should increase gradually. Novelty should reveal understanding rather than introduce unrelated obstacles.

34. Retention

Retention requires a meaningful interval without complete re-teaching. Review may provide cues, but cues must not reconstruct the answer so fully that memory is not tested.

Future standards must define initial review windows, consolidation checks, lapsed-knowledge criteria, and reactivation procedures.

35. Fluency

Fluency may be retrieval, navigation, execution, rhythmic, conceptual, or musical. It **MUST** include accuracy and flexibility. Fast responses that fail under minor variation are not fluent.

36. Mastery

Mastery is the demonstrated ability to perform or apply a defined capability with sufficient accuracy, stability, understanding, retention, transfer, and independence for its intended future use.

Every mastery claim **MUST** include capability, scope, conditions, quality standard, and intended future use. Mastery is not perfection, permanence, universal generalization, or a score alone.

FretGarden distinguishes functional mastery, sufficient to support the next learning demand, from comprehensive mastery, which is retained, transferable, fluent, and integrated.

37. Readiness and Progression

Progression depends on readiness rather than finishing content. Prerequisites must be classified as required, strongly recommended, supporting, or enrichment. Progression rules must state the evidence level required for every required prerequisite.

38. Evidence Profiles

FretGarden **SHOULD** preserve evidence as a profile rather than one number. A profile may include objective level, accuracy, prompting, response speed, last independent and delayed success, context variety, transfer evidence, common error, and recommended next action.

This requirement is pedagogical rather than technical: important distinctions must not be erased by premature aggregation.

39. Confidence in Claims

Capability status and confidence in that status **SHOULD** remain distinct. Confidence depends on evidence quantity, diversity, recency, and consistency. Low confidence does not mean low capability; it means more evidence is needed.

40. Objective Alignment

Every unit must align objective, instruction, practice, feedback, assessment, progression, and review. Misalignment occurs when understanding is taught but recognition alone is tested, accuracy is practiced but speed is rewarded, transfer is claimed without variation, or rhythm is part of the objective but omitted from feedback.

41. Lesson Objective Requirements

Every core lesson **MUST** include one primary objective, any secondary objectives, prerequisites, an evidence statement, intended developmental level, permitted support, scope, quality dimensions, retrieval plan, delayed-review plan, and contribution to later musicianship.

42. Exercise Objective Requirements

Every exercise **MUST** identify the objective it serves, its instructional purpose, the evidence it produces, likely errors, and the conditions under which the result may be interpreted.

43. Assessment Objective Requirements

Every assessment **MUST** state the capability measured, claim supported, evidence source, support level, sampling plan, quality criteria, likely confounds, and limits of interpretation.

44. Review Objective Requirements

Every review activity **SHOULD** identify whether it reactivates knowledge, strengthens retrieval, verifies retention, increases fluency, interleaves concepts, tests transfer, repairs error, or integrates knowledge.

45. Diagnostic Objectives

Diagnostic tasks seek causes of difficulty. They **SHOULD** reduce unrelated demands, isolate likely subskills, compare supported and unsupported performance, vary one difficulty factor at a time, and produce actionable remediation.

46. Negative and Missing Evidence

Negative evidence occurs when a learner has a valid opportunity and does not demonstrate the capability. Missing evidence occurs when the task does not provide a valid opportunity. Missing evidence produces uncertainty, not a failing judgment.

47. Evidence Expiration and Revalidation

Evidence becomes less useful over time, especially for critical, physical, rarely used, or previously unstable capabilities. Old mastery records **MUST NOT** guarantee current readiness when evidence of decay exists.

48. Learner-Facing Claims

Learner-facing language must accurately reflect evidence. Permitted language includes introduced, practicing with guidance, independent in familiar examples, stable across recent attempts, retained after review, applying in new contexts, and mastered within this scope.

Claims such as completely known, perfect, or fluent **MUST NOT** be used when the evidence does not support them.

49. Conformance Tests

A conforming objective must answer:

- 1 What capability should change?
- 2 Which taxonomy domain is primary?
- 3 What content and scope are included?
- 4 Under what conditions must the capability be available?
- 5 What support is permitted?
- 6 What quality dimensions matter?

- 7 What developmental level is intended?
- 8 What evidence will reveal the capability?
- 9 How could success occur without the intended capability?
- 10 How will guessing be controlled?
- 11 How will retention be distinguished from immediate performance?
- 12 What variation will establish transfer?
- 13 What evidence is required for progression and mastery?
- 14 How will failure be diagnosed?
- 15 How will delayed review occur?
- 16 How does the objective contribute to independence?

50. Examples of Compliant Objectives

50.1 Note Retrieval

Given a named natural note and no fretboard reference, the learner will locate that note on the sixth and fifth strings between the open string and twelfth fret with the required task-specific accuracy across varied item order, independently during the learning session and again after delay.

50.2 Interval Construction

Given a root on the sixth, fifth, or fourth string, the learner will construct a perfect fifth in at least two available configurations, name the interval, and explain its pitch relationship without a complete diagram.

50.3 Rhythmic Execution

Given a steady quarter-note pulse and a two-measure pattern containing quarter notes, eighth notes, and rests in simple meter, the learner will count and perform the pattern while maintaining alignment at a controlled tempo.

50.4 Chord-Tone Application

Given a familiar two-chord progression and defined fretboard region, the learner will improvise a short phrase that intentionally resolves to a chord tone on each change and identify the selected chord tones afterward.

50.5 Practice Regulation

Given a passage that breaks down, the learner will identify the unstable segment, choose an appropriate reduction in tempo or scope, perform corrected repetitions, and state the condition required before increasing difficulty.

51. Examples of Noncompliant Objectives

“Understand the fretboard,” “complete the major-scale lesson,” “practice note names for ten minutes,” “learn all intervals,” “play faster,” and “master chords” are noncompliant because they lack defined capability, scope, conditions, evidence, or quality requirements.

An objective claiming recall but assessed only by multiple choice is noncompliant. An objective claiming rhythm but measured only by passage completion is noncompliant.

52. Constitutional Non-Negotiables

- 1 Every core objective MUST define an observable or inferable learner capability.
- 2 Topic labels MUST NOT substitute for objectives.
- 3 Activities MUST NOT be represented as outcomes.
- 4 Every core objective MUST include an evidence statement.
- 5 Every mastery claim MUST be scoped.
- 6 Recognition MUST NOT be treated as recall.
- 7 Immediate performance MUST NOT be treated as retention.
- 8 Exact repetition MUST NOT be treated as broad transfer.
- 9 Prompted success MUST NOT be treated as independence.
- 10 Completion MUST NOT be treated as capability.
- 11 A single correct response MUST NOT establish mastery.
- 12 Evidence conditions MUST be considered.
- 13 Assessments MUST match the domain and claim.
- 14 Core objectives MUST include delayed review.
- 15 Broad claims SHOULD use converging evidence.
- 16 Integrated tasks MUST identify prerequisites.
- 17 Error evidence MUST inform remediation.
- 18 Self-report MUST NOT independently establish core capability.
- 19 Speed MUST NOT compensate for inaccuracy.
- 20 Learner-facing language MUST not exceed the evidence.

53. Tradeoffs and Resolution Rules

Precision increases authoring burden, but vague objectives create larger long-term costs. Controlled assessment improves diagnosis, while authentic tasks reveal integration; FretGarden should use both. Strong evidence may slow visible progression, but weak progression produces later failure; statuses should distinguish exposure, developing capability, functional readiness, and comprehensive mastery. Standardized outcomes should permit varied valid demonstrations. Efficient tasks may support low-stakes practice, while consequential claims require stronger evidence. Response speed belongs only where future musical use requires it.

54. Assumptions Made

This chapter assumes that FretGarden will track learning more precisely than lesson completion; objective domains require different evidence; core concepts recur across sessions; some capabilities are demonstrated on the instrument; progression depends on prerequisites; support levels are distinguishable; development is uneven across domains; mastery remains scoped; and later chapters will define task-specific thresholds and intervals.

55. Unresolved Questions

Unresolved matters include whether all domains share learner-facing level labels, task-specific accuracy thresholds, standard retention intervals, when timing becomes part of fluency, creative-work evidence, limits of automated observation, evidence aggregation, learner overrides, accessible alternate demonstrations, and portability across instruments or tunings.

56. Topics Intentionally Deferred

Deferred topics include lesson architecture, exercise design, assessment construction, mastery thresholds, progression rules, prerequisite graphs, spaced-review schedules, interleaving, adaptive difficulty, remediation, error taxonomy, feedback, domain-specific assessment, creative-work rubrics, placement, analytics, confidence calculations, accessibility, automated evaluation, progress representation, revalidation, and quality assurance.

57. Required Future Cross-References

The lesson-architecture chapter must reference Sections 3 through 6, 17 through 19, 40, 41, and 49. Exercise design must reference Sections 20 through 24, 30 through 33, 42, and 52. Assessment must reference Sections 21 through 29, 34 through 39, 43, and 46 through 48. Mastery and progression must reference Sections 18, 25, 26, 34 through 39, and 37. Review must reference Sections 18.7, 25.7, 34, 44, and 47. Domain-specific chapters must reference their corresponding taxonomy domains and examples.

58. Chapter Conformance Statement

A FretGarden objective conforms only when it defines a learner capability, content scope, relevant conditions, quality standard, support level, developmental level, and evidence required for the intended claim.

An evidence claim conforms only when the source is relevant, conditions are known, interpretation does not exceed evidence, guessing and prompting are accounted for, immediate performance is distinguished from retention, and mastery is based on stable, independent, retained, and transferable capability appropriate to scope.

No educational artifact may be approved solely because it appears educational, requires effort, produces a score, or resembles common instructional practice. It must establish a defensible relationship among objective, evidence, and claim.